

# LET IT BLOSSOM LET IT FLOW



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Innovation is technology that makes life easy for the masses. But it's not easy to think out of the box.



## STAND OUT. BE A LITTLE CRAZY.

American physicist Robert Hutchings Goddard was ridiculed for his theories on space flight. What he designed as weapons have actually taken man to moon and beyond. So until what you have built or redefined becomes the norm, you will be the crank in town.



## EMBRACE FAILURE. LEARN FROM IT.

We cannot innovate unless we are willing to learn from our mistakes. There are several companies that give the freedom to innovate. In Google, employees can use 20 per cent of their working hours to develop whatever they want. The result, projects like gmail and Orkut. Soichiro Honda was turned down by Toyota and he remained jobless until neighbours began buying his homemade scooters. Today, the company has become the world's largest motorcycle manufacturer.



## CROSS-BREED IDEAS. COLLIDE WITH OTHER UNIVERSES.

Great ideas are born when two well-defined boundaries collide. It's in those outer layers that new applications, ideas and innovations are born. Interact and work with people who are the best at what they do, but don't do what you do. Most major subjects that have grown into industries of their own were all once merely sparks between two different boundaries. For instance, computer science is the child of pure and logic mathematics.



## TREAT CONSTRAINTS AS YOUR FRIENDS

Projects defined by the imaginary "unlimited supply of resources" rarely produce innovative results. It's the constraints that produce the extraordinary. Most amazing products never get out of the lab. If they do, most of them fail. One of the key reasons is that they are not built to withstand the realities of markets and stiff competition.



## BREAK PATTERNS. THEY ARE THE ENEMY.

Constantly question the fundamentals of how things work, and how they can be redefined. Go back to the roots of being an argumentative Indian. Question your laws, test your boundaries. It is not necessary that if you think something is stupid, it will not work.



## NURTURE DIVERSITY. PEOPLE CARRY INSIGHTS.

Be committed to your commitment, but be flexible on the route to get there. Research is not just the work that you do, but about the people who do the work, because innovation innately is all about building a product that finds its adoption in the hands of a customer.



## SOLVE A BASIC PROBLEM. FOCUS ON IMPACT.

There is a lot of associated glamour with wanting to build the products of the future, but redefining the present is harder. It still amazes me

that the company which owns the Jaguar, also owns the world's cheapest car. We live in a time when most products are not built for emerging markets. If you innovate for emerging markets, you indeed change the world.



## NEVER STOP LEARNING

The day you stop learning, you are ready to retire and the best of days are behind you. As experience grows, people stop learning. Suddenly there is an image to protect and there is pressure to perform better than what you did last time. Continue to stay with the attitude with which you first started, and evolve as time does. Don't become a dodo, worse a liability.



## CREDIT YOUR TEAM

Give your team due credit. Talent can take you to the top, but only character keeps you there. And one's character is shown by the team that surrounds and follows. The global IT solutions company, Mindtree Limited, has people like Subroto Bagchi and Krishna Kumar who believe in teamwork.



## BE HUMAN. LET YOUR WORK RELATE TO PEOPLE.

Whatever you build is innovative only if it is embraced by the people it could help. While research is focused, innovation helps in commercialising a product. Most times, making something human, means making it simple.